GENERAL ACADEMIC TUTORING

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Technical University
of Applied Sciences
Würzburg-Schweinfurt

Working in Germany

THWS International Students' Tutor
Ertugrul Kiyici

TODAY'S TOPICS

TODAY'S TOPICS

1. Working in Germany as a Student
2. Regulations for Students (work permit etc.)
3. Tax Nr. and Social Security Information
4. Insurance for Work (Health, Pension etc.)
5. Certificates & Qualifications
6. Places to Work (in Schweinfurt & Würzburg)
7. Flexible Job Opportunities by Apps and Web
8. Questions

WORKING IN GERMANY & EU-REGULATIONS FOR STUDENTS

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- **Are there any time restrictions?**
  - ✓ Students are allowed to work for **(max.) 20 hours per week during the semester (general rule).**

- **Students from non-EU countries:**
  - ✓ May work **140 full days (full-time)** or **280 half days (part-time) per year**. If you work as a student assistant at a university or a company, the number of days may be higher.
- **Students from EU countries:**
  - ✓ There are no restrictions!

For more info please visit:

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- **How much am I allowed to earn without paying tax?**

  - ✓ You can earn **up to 556,00 euros a month (as of 01.2025)** on a **student job** without paying taxes (income tax).

  - ✓ But if you regularly **earn more than 556,00 euros**, you need to pay taxes (income tax & some additional taxes). A certain amount is then deducted from your wages every month, which you get back* when you file a **German tax return form at the end of the year (tax refund)**.

  - ✓ **For more info please visit: https://www.daad.de/en/studying-in-germany/work-career/side-jobs/**
  - ✓ https://www.study-in-germany.de/en/germany/everyday-life/work/

Study in Germany Land of Ideas

AN INITIATIVE OF THE Federal Ministry of Education and Research

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Mini-Job and Tax Free Allowance Limit (Grundfreibetrag):

- If you have a **mini-job (up to €556)** (**as of 01.2025**) you do **not have to pay taxes / social security contributions (total annual amount= €6,672)**.

- **Tax free allowance limit (Grundfreibetrag):** If you **earn less than €12,096 a year (as of 2025)** you will get back the taxes you have paid at the end of the year **if you submit an income tax return form (Steurbescheid)** to the tax authority in your city.

- Basically if you're a **working student earning €556 a month**, your **annual (12 moths total) salary (=€6,672)** will be below this allowance **(€12,096)** means that you won't need to pay any taxes! **So no need to make a tax refund stuff either!**

For more info please visit: https://www.internationale-studierende.de/en/during-your-studies/jobbing?L=1

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- ✓ If you have a **mini-job (monthly up to €556)** **(as of 01.2025)** you do **not have to pay taxes / social security contributions (total annual amount= €6,672)**. Between **€556,01 - €2000** is called midi-job.

- ✓ Jobs taken during the **semester break** are subject **to income tax** in every condition.

- ✓ If the job is carried out **only during lecture-free** time **you do not have to pay** any additional health insurance contributions, **even if you work more than 20 hours a week**. **These jobs are usually called "short-term"/ Kurzfristige Beschäftigung.**

- ✓ During **Urlaub Semester (Holiday Semester)** the obligation to pay social security contributions may not be applicable: this applies if the employment **is limited to a maximum of 3 months or 70 working days per year**.

***More information is available here**

TAX REFUND

- **What should I do for tax refund?**

- ✓ For **tax refund**, you must hand in **a tax declaration (Steuerbescheid) to the tax authority** [tax department (Finanzamt) in your city]**(physical way)**.
- ✓ They will check and if you paid extra taxes, they will **refund the extra amount**, if necessary. **Not all of it!**
- ✓ You can hand in a **tax declaration form** retroactively for the **past years (up to 4 years) by online system (online way)**.
- ✓ https://taxfix.page.link/xRnc

WORKING AT SEMESTER BREAK AND HOLIDAY SEMESTER

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Working during the Semester Break and Holiday Semester (Urlaub Semester):

- Jobs taken **during the semester break** are normally subject to income tax (*because it is not a studying time anymore so there will be no 20 hours limit per week*) but still you can get back the taxes (if you are earning **less than the tax free allowance limit**) that you have paid at the end of the year via the **tax return/refund**. **[This also depends if you have Mini-job, Short-Term Employment (Kurzfristige Beschäftigung) or Full-Time Employment]**

- If the job is carried out **only during lecture-free time** (e.g.: semester breaks) you do not have to pay any **additional health insurance contributions**, **even if you work more than 20 hours per week**.

- During the **Urlaub Semester (Holiday Semester)** the obligation to pay **social security contributions may not be applicable**: this can apply **if the employment is limited to a maximum of 3 months contract duration or 70 working days per year.**

GERMAN TAX ID NR. AND SOCIAL SECURITY NR.

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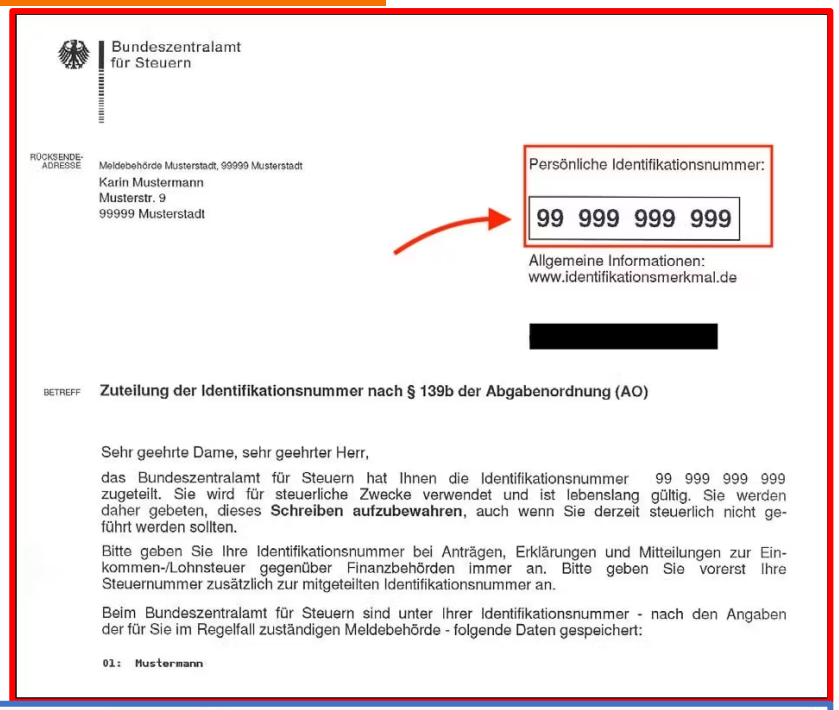
- **How can I receive my German Tax ID Number (Identifikationsnummer) ?**

- ✓ After completing the process of **registering to the city (*Wohnsitzanmeldung*),** with in **4 weeks** you will receive the document that shows your German Tax ID (Identifikationsnummer) **by post to your registered German address**.

- **How can I register and get my German Social Security Number (Versicherungsnummernachweis)?**

- ✓ Once you **start a job and fill the documents**, the place that you work is going to register you to German Social Security System and you will receive your German Social Security number **by post to your registered German address.**



Bundeszentralamt für Steuern

RÜCKSENDE-ADRESSE
Meldebehörde Musterstadt, 99999 Musterstadt
Karin Mustermann
Musterstr. 9
99999 Musterstadt

Persönliche Identifikationsnummer:
99 999 999 999

Allgemeine Informationen:
www.identifikationsmerkmal.de

[redacted]

BETREFF **Zuteilung der Identifikationsnummer nach § 139b der Abgabenordnung (AO)**

Sehr geehrte Dame, sehr geehrter Herr,

das Bundeszentralamt für Steuern hat Ihnen die Identifikationsnummer 99 999 999 999 zugeteilt. Sie wird für steuerliche Zwecke verwendet und ist lebenslang gültig. Sie werden daher gebeten, dieses **Schreiben aufzubewahren**, auch wenn Sie derzeit steuerlich nicht geführt werden sollten.

Bitte geben Sie Ihre Identifikationsnummer bei Anträgen, Erklärungen und Mitteilungen zur Einkommen-/Lohnsteuer gegenüber Finanzbehörden immer an. Bitte geben Sie vorerst Ihre Steuernummer zusätzlich zur mitgeteilten Identifikationsnummer an.

Beim Bundeszentralamt für Steuern sind unter Ihrer Identifikationsnummer - nach den Angaben der für Sie im Regelfall zuständigen Meldebehörde - folgende Daten gespeichert:

01: Mustermann

Deutsche Rentenversicherung

Versicherungsnummernachweis

Social Insurance Card
Carte de sécurité sociale
Tessera di previdenza sociale
Tarjeta de afiliación a la Seguridad Social
Ταυτοτητα Κοινωνικων Ασφαλισεων
Legitimacija o socijalnom osiguranju
Sosyal sigortalar kimliği
Legitymacja ubezpieczenia społecznego

Versicherungsnummer:
12 123456 M 123

Name, Vorname:
Mustermann, Max

Geburtsname:
****

ausgestellt am:
10.01.2023

Ausweisnummer:
A 1234567

HEALTH INSURANCE/NURSING CARE CONTRIBUTION

- ✓ Even if you have a side job, **students are usually insured as students and not as employees.**
- ✓ In that case **you do not have to make** any income related contributions (such as nursing care payment) towards health insurance.
- ✓ Under some circumstances, **if you work more than 20 hours a week**, you would have to pay a contribution to health insurance. Please **clarify this** beforehand **with your employer!**

SOCIAL SECURITY/PENSION INSURANCE

- ✓ An income of **up to €556 Euro** is exempted from contribution.
- ✓ With an income **between €556 and €2,000** per month **or more than 20 working hours** per week the amount is reduced. Whoever earns more, pays higher contributions.
- ✓ Starting from an income of € 2,000 per month students **pay the full share** of **9.3 %.** When you work **less than 20** hours per week, **you can remain** insured by the **student health insurance**.
- ✓ When working **more than 20 hours per week**, you will have to pay contributions to pension insurance, as well as health, nursing care and unemployment insurance.

CERTIFICATES FOR WORKING (GASTRONOMY)

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- ✓ Depending on the kind of job you want, you may have to get some **“special” certificates**.
- ✓ For example, if you want to work in the **Gastronomy industry (restaurants, catering, food production etc.)**, you will need a special **health certificate (Gesundheitszeugnis)** through an instruction.
- ✓ This involves just **one lecture (about 3 hrs)** on health and food, after that you need to pass the test.
- ✓ If you succed, you will receive your **certificate immediately (online)**.
- ✓ You can find a course online. You need to use your certificate in 3 months.
- ✓ It costs about **€25-€30 also according to your contact your employer can pay it**.

***More information is available here**

Bescheinigung des Gesundheitsamtes / beauftragten Arztes nach § 43 Abs. 1 Infektionsschutzgesetz (IfSG)*

Name: Mustermann
Vorname: Max
Anschrift: Ritterstr. 9, 10969 Berlin
beschäftigt als: Lebensmittelbereich
tätig bei: InStaff & Jobs GmbH

O. g. wurde gemäß § 43 Abs. 1 IfSG schriftlich durch Aushändigen eines Merkblattes gemäß den Empfehlungen des Robert Koch Instituts sowie mündlich über die in § 42 Abs. 1 genannten Tätigkeitsverbote und über die Verpflichtungen nach den Absätzen 2, 4 und 5 des § 42 IfSG belehrt. Anhaltspunkte dafür, dass Hinderungsgründe nach § 42 Abs. 1 IfSG bestehen, liegen nicht vor.

Datum Stempel und Unterschrift (Gesundheitsamt / beauftragter Arzt)

Im Anschluss an die vorstehende Belehrung erkläre ich, dass mir keine Tatsachen bekannt sind, die ein Tätigkeitsverbot nach § 42 Abs. 1 des Infektionsschutzgesetzes für mich zur Folge haben könnten.

Datum Unterschrift des Arbeitnehmers

Ich bestätige, dass ich nach der Datenschutzverordnung (DSGVO) - Merkblatt informiert worden bin und das Merkblatt erhalten habe.

Datum Unterschrift des Arbeitnehmers

* Diese Bescheinigung ist vom jeweiligen Arbeitgeber aufzubewahren und verfügbar zu halten.

FINDING A JOB

- You can use the **online job platform of the university** to look for different type of jobs and areas: https://jobboerse.thws.de/index.php/en

- You can look for work through **popular Job Search Sites**: www.wuewowas.de or www.wuejobber.de , www.stepstone.de , www.indeed.com or on www.linkedin.com

- **Stores** and **restaurants** often display job offers on posters **in their windows**

- Also check THWS &,

- Julius- Maximilians-Universität Würzburg offers (e.g. on Instagram, infoboards)

***More information is available on the THWS Career Service website here**

RESUME & MOTIVATION LETTER

- ✓ In Germany you mostly apply with a **CV** and, depending on the job, also with a **motivational letter**. Most **student jobs** are **rather informal** though and don't require the motivational letter.
- ✓ CVs in Germany **usually have** your contact information, education, job experience, your competencies and some free-time activities to get to know your personality better. A photo is usually appreciated, too. CV should be **1-2 pages max**.
- ✓ Use a bullet point format and keep phrases short for readability. Think about adding **only relevant experience** and information.

- ✓ Usually you **submit** your CV **online**, but you can also just bring it to the business personally. They tend to take some days to review, and then call or email you **(make sure the contact info on your CV is correct!)** to invite you to a short interview or a trial day.

APPLICATION

*More information is available on the THWS Career Service website here.

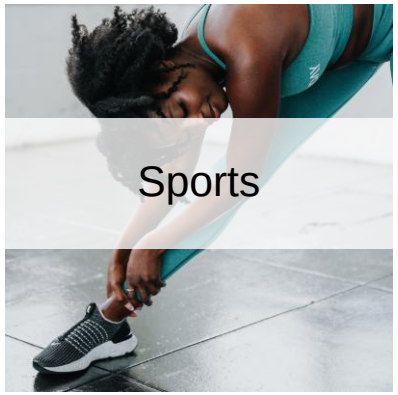
INTERVIEW TIPS

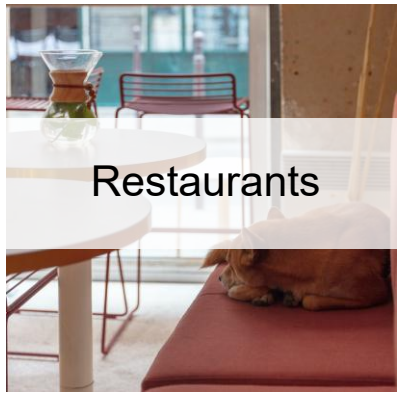
- ✓ In interviews, **always be polite and respectful.**
- ✓ **Practice in advance** how to shortly introduce yourself, speak about your experience and your strengths. Other than that: **Just be confident and honest.**
- ✓ Most **interviews for student jobs** aren't very long or stressful. It's more to see if your character fits the team and potentially discuss working hours.
- ✓ **Prepare some questions**. This will show your interest in the job offer.
- ✓ **Arrive in time.** Rather be too early than too late at your future employer. **If you are running late**, let your interview partner know as soon as possible.
- ✓ After the interview, **regularly check** your e-mail account. **Wait for a week**, and if you haven't received a response by then, reach out to the HR manager to clarify the company's decision.

***More information is available on the THWS Career Service website here:**

NEXT WEEK'S TOPICS

OPPORTUNITIES AND OFFERS IN WÜ & SW





TIME FOR QUESTIONS!

ertugrul.kiyici@study.thws.de

THANK YOU